

SAHPATHI 2018

CHHATTISGARH CHAPTER



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Introduction

Basic Idea

Sahpathi is the extension of the Road Teachers project, which was organized in June-July 2016 and continued in June- July 2017. The third phase which is also the fourth batch of Sahpathi was organized in the June- July 2018. In the last two years, it was conducted in selected residential schools for children from Scheduled Tribe (ST) and Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group (PVTG) households, run by the Department of Welfare, Government of Jharkhand. Sahpathi 2018 saw its collaboration with the Department of Tribal and Scheduled Caste Development, Government of Chhattisgarh. The programme was also assisted by Chaupal Gramin Vikas Prashikshan Evam Shodh Sansthan in Sarguja district, Chhattisgarh where the residential schools were located. Students from various colleges and universities across the country participated as volunteers in the programme. The volunteers stayed in the residential schools with the children and conducted curricular, co-curricular and extra-curricular activities and made observations about the schools. The idea is that volunteers and students in the residential schools become ‘*Sahpathis*’ (that is, ‘co-learners’) during the course of the programme and together explore possible ways of supporting and reviving these schools. The programme was initiated by Jean Drèze and Reetika Khera and, this year, coordinated by Apurva Bamezai, Akash Ranjan, Sabah Maharaj and Snehashish Das.¹

When and Where

The programme for this year was conducted from 16th June to 2nd July 2018. It started with an orientation workshop on the 16th and the 17th of June and ended with a debriefing workshop on the 2nd of July. Volunteers were posted in residential schools for Adivasi children, managed by the Department of Welfare, Government of Jharkhand and Department of Tribal and Scheduled Caste Development, Government of Chhattisgarh or (in some cases) entrusted by it to NGOs. The programme received cooperation from both of the Departments from the very beginning. Initially, the programme focused on a few districts of Jharkhand relatively close to Ranchi (Ranchi, Gumla, Latehar, Khunti and Lohardaga). However, this year, Sahpathi could only focus

¹ For any information related to the Sahpathi Programme, please write to snehashishdas739@gmail.com or a.bamezai@gmail.com.

on the schools of Gumla, Latehar and Lohardaga district, and extend itself to Sarguja district of Chhattisgarh. The 11 schools that were covered are:

Schools from Jharkhand:

1. Jobhipat, Gumla district (Boys).
2. Sakhuapani, Gumla district (Boys).
3. Chapatoli, Gumla district (Girls).
4. Netarhat, Latehar district (Girls).
5. Lohardaga, Lohardaga district (girls).

Schools from Chhattisgarh:

1. Marya, Sarguja district (Co-education).
2. Govindpur, Sarguja district (Boys).
3. Baijnathpur, Sarguja district (Boys).
4. Tirang, Sarguja district (Boys).
5. Chirga, Sarguja district (Girls).
6. Bhatko, Sarguja district (Girls).

Activities

The volunteers were expected to teach, play and conduct activities in the schools, help them in daily routines, develop innovative teaching methods or teaching aids, make the school environment more child-friendly, coordinate with the teachers and find ways of improving the school.

Volunteers were free to decide on the activities they wished to conduct and ways of engaging with the schools according to what they thought suited the school best.

An orientation and training session over 1.5 days was organized for the volunteers before they departed for the schools, and a day-long debriefing session was conducted at the end of the volunteers' stay. The training programme is discussed briefly in Annex A.



Photos from the Orientation Training Workshop and the Debriefing, Sahpathi 2018

Resources

With the approval and support of the respective Department(s), the residential schools agreed to arrange local hospitality (food and accommodation) for the volunteers. Travel expenses to and

from Jharkhand (train fare, sleeper class by the shortest route) were reimbursed to those who stayed for at least two weeks and requested reimbursement.

Funding

We collected individual donations with no strings attached for this purpose.

Volunteers' Details

A total of 37 volunteers participated in Sahpathi 2018. Details of the volunteers are mentioned in the list given below.

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1	Arunabh Konwar	adkpost17@gmail.com	M
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35	Natasha Khan	natasha.khan@niser.ac.in	F
36	Padmini Rajoria	prajoria811@gmail.com	F
37	Hemashree Alase	psychosniperhema@gmail.com	F



Team Sahpathi 2018 (Coordinators, Volunteers and the Well Wishers)

Beyond July 2018

This is not just a one-off project, but an experiment aimed at exploring possible ways of helping the concerned schools on a more sustained basis. All the volunteers have been asked to write a short note about their experience, observations and suggestions. This will help us to assess the state of the schools and find ways of supporting them in the future. We are also hoping that some volunteers will write for a wider audience.

Activities with Students

During the volunteers' stay at various schools, they conducted various curricular, co-curricular and extra-curricular activities. In the class hours, students used to self-study due to the lack of adequate number of teachers. The volunteers, in their first few days, took time to understand how the school functioned and soon started taking classes in classrooms which were devoid of teachers. The volunteers used NCERT textbooks, worksheets, charts and other interactive learning tools to conduct these classes.

However, it was in the post-school hours that the volunteers could step beyond the paradigm of the school curriculum and engage the students in activities which ensured the holistic development of the students. The range of activities includes painting, dancing, letter writing, gender sensitisation, games, theatre workshops, etc. A list of activities follows this section.

The volunteers who had been a part of Sahpathi in the previous years helped in maintaining continuity in the programme. The activities conducted were based on the understanding of facilitating change and becoming co-learners in the process of exploration with the children. Most volunteers returned with overwhelming experiences of having questioned the spaces of privilege they acquire and drawing inspiration from the enthusiastic students who displayed a knack to learn despite the lack of resources in their immediate context.

Curriculum-related Activities

Various co-curricular and extra-curricular activities were conducted by the volunteers. A list of the activities conducted is given below, followed by a collection of photographs of the same.

- Alphabet and number training
- Mathematical Operations
- Poem Recitation
- General Knowledge Quiz
- Strengthening fundamentals

Co-curricular and Extra-curricular Activities

- Painting

- Origami
- Letter-writing
- Street plays
- Dance
- Singing songs in tribal languages and other vernacular languages
- Sports matches
- Documentary screening
- Theatre exercise
- PT session
- Introduction to the Indian Constitution and Fundamental Rights
- Village planning
- Reciting life histories
- Oral hygiene awareness campaign
- Alcohol and tobacco sensitisation
- Gender sensitisation
- Safe-Unsafe Touch
- Menstrual and reproductive health awareness
- Setting up library
- Setting up the student council through elections
- Discussion on identity
- Session on bullying, discrimination, etc.
- Environmental awareness campaign
- Identifying scientific/unscientific claims
- Story-telling
 - Pictures of the activities are attached in the following pages



Painting Sessions



Che- Kung - Session

Meditation with the Students





Sessions on
Map
Education



Sessions on Human Organs

Sessions on Democracy and Voting



Movie
Screenings





Setting up Libraries



Activities with
Cards and
Papers



Yoga



Origami





Fun Games



Cultural Activities



Observations, Issues and Concerns

Most schools visited as a part of the programme had basic facilities and a wide set of deficiencies. Volunteers stayed in these schools for two weeks and identified the several problems that act as road-blocks to the smooth functioning of these schools. The general observations regarding all the schools are discussed below, followed by school-wise observations:

Infrastructure

- Lack of basic amenities such as:
 - Water
 - Electricity
 - Functional toilets and bathrooms
- . Lack of playground and boundary wall

Food

- The prescribed school menu is not followed at all.
- The quality and quantity of food is questionable.
- Drinking water is not filtered.
- Meal timings are arbitrary.

Staffing

- Absence of warden/hostel-in charges from school campus.
- Inadequate teaching staff
- Absence of security guards
- Lack of delegation of work for non-teaching staff

Other Issues

- Lack of medical care
- Discrimination against Pahadi Korwa students
- Child labour

Feedback Table

- A table with feedback received from the volunteer groups about each of the 8 schools visited as part of the programme is presented below.

SL NO.	Details	Chirga	Tirang	Biajnathpur	Govindpur	Marya	Bhatko
1.	Does the school have the following facilities? <i>[Y = Yes; N = No; N/A = Unclear]</i>						
	Electricity connection	Y	Y	Y	Y	N/A	Y
	Regular electricity supply	N	Y	N	N/A	N	N
	Handpump(operational) with clean water	Y	Y	N	N	Y	Y
	Functional toilet(s) for children	N	Y	Y	Y	N	Y
	Functional bathroom(s) for children	N	Y	Y	Y	N	N
	Functional computer(s)	N	N	N	N	Y	N
	Functional library	Y	N	N	N	N/A	N
	Functional science lab	N	N	N	N	N	N
	Boundary wall with gate	Y	N	N	N	Y	Y

	Cooking place in hygienic condition	Y	N/A	N	Y	N	Y
	Play ground	N	Y	N	N/A	N	N
	Adequate play equipments for all age groups	N	Y	N	N	N	N
	First aid box	N	Y	N	N	N	Y
2.	How many of the following water supply facilities does the school have? <i>[If none, write "0".]</i>						
	Functional handpump(or any other source in school premises) with clean water	1	2	0	0	1	N/A
	Functional handpump with contaminated water	0	0	1	0	1	1
	Non-functional handpump	0	0	1	0	0	0
	Functional borewell	0	1	1	0	0	1
3	How many functional toilets, accessible to children, does the school have?	3	3	3	3	0	11

4.	Do children normally have a bath inside or outside the school campus? <i>[1 = Inside; 2 = Outside; 3 = Both; 9 = Unclear]</i>	1	1	2	2	2	1
5.	How many persons have been appointed in the following posts?						
	Teachers (regular)- M	0	4	2	0	0	0
	Teachers (regular)- F	2	0	0	0	0	1
	Teachers (contract)- M	0	0	0	2	3	0
	Teachers (contract)- F	0	0	0	0	0	5
	Hostel warden	1	1	0	1	1	0
	Cooks	1	6	0	6	1	5
	Watchman/security guard	0	1	1	0	0	1
	Cleaning or maintenance staff	2	N/A	5	0	0	N/A
	Accountant	0	0	0	0	0	0
	Other (specify)	Peon- 1					Nurse- 1
6.	Did the Principal attend school						

	regularly during your stay? <i>[Y = Yes; N = No; N/A = Unclear]</i>	N	Y	N	Y	N/A	Y
7.	On an average day, how many teachers were present at the school during teaching hours?	2	4	2	2	1	4
8.	Did the school conduct any health checkups in the last 6 months? <i>[Y = Yes; N = No; N/A = Unclear]</i>	N	N/A	N	N	N	Y
9.	How would you rate the nutritious value of the food that was being given to children? <i>[1 = Very good; 2 = Good; 3 = So-so; 4 = Poor; 5 = Very poor]</i>	4	4	4	4	4	4



No Garbage Disposal System in Baijnathpur



Unhealthy and Deteriorated Food Items in Baijnathpur and Govindpur Schools



Insects in the Food in Govindpur School



Students Engaged in Domestic Chores in Baijnathpur School.



Unutilized Drinking Water Supply Machine in Tirang School



Unhygienic Cooking Places in Mareya and Govindpur Schools



Toilets and Washrooms in the Schools

School-wise Observations

Chirga

Infrastructure

- The school does not have regular water supply. This is due to infrequent and unreliable electricity supply. The residents of the school then fetch water from the neighbour's bore well, but this is also an unreliable source due to electrical and wiring issues
- Of the six toilets in total, three are well-functioning and used regularly. The cubicles for bathing remain unused due to the lack of direct water supply in the bathrooms. The toilet complex lacks lighting facilities.
- The electricity supply in the school is highly irregular and the school has to rely on the alternative choice of solar panels, which fluctuate with the onset of monsoons.
- The school lacks a playground; this is an impediment that bars students from engaging in sports and cultural activities. Currently, any student activity takes place in the corridors.

food

- All meals for the students comprise rice, *dal* and a preparation of any seasonal vegetable with potato. The students are fed rice thrice a day with the exception of *suji* being served on Sunday mornings. Quantity of vegetable is compromised and the *dal* is watery. There is a complete lack of milk and fruits in their daily diet.
- The meal timings are such that the gap between breakfast and lunch is merely three hours, while that between dinner and breakfast is more than twelve hours. Although there is a time set aside for evening tea, students are rarely served any snacks during this time.
- There is no provision for filtering water in the school and drinking water is fetched from the neighbour's bore well. The water consumed by students has high iron content.

Staffing

1. Teaching staff

- For five classes, the school has three teachers. As a result, Classes 1 and 2 are combined. On an average, two classes remain without teacher supervision.
- The Principal cum warden of the school is also a teacher. However, she is never on campus during school hours and even when present, only cares for administrative duties.

- The teachers are content with and even prefer the system of biometric attendance registration for the students. They do not face major connectivity issues, but charging the device appears to be problematic given the unreliability of electricity connection. No problems seem to arise with respect to internet connectivity.
- One of the two teachers brings her children along with her to school. They require constant attention and interrupt her teaching.

2. *Non-teaching staff*

- The warden does not stay on campus and visits the school for two to three hours every day. She does not delegate her duties and in her absence, a considerable number of problems go unattended.
- In the absence of the warden, the peon becomes the only staff member on campus post 6 pm. Consequently, she is solely responsible for the welfare of the school as well as the children.
- The security guard remained absent throughout the month of June and is expected to rejoin by the first week of July. No explanation was provided to the team for such absence.

3. *Common complaint*

- All staff members complained of delay in the receipt of their salaries by three to four months.

Other Issues

- Child labour : The team witnessed students carrying water from the village hand pump which is 300-400 meters away from the school campus and the neighbour's bore well which is nearly a 150 meters away. On several occasions, students were also found carrying branches of fallen trees and weeding the school garden. Although the school has employed three peons, the students mop and sweep their classrooms as well as the dorm rooms.
- It was found that a considerable number of mosquito nets used by the students had holes in them.
- The money allocated annually to the operation of the school is Rs 5000. The hostel operates on an annual budget of Rs 4,50,000. This money is received *in toto* by the hostel as Rs 900 per month for the welfare of each child. Since the capacity of the school on record is 50 children, the annual budget for the hostel, which runs for 10 months, is Rs 4,50,000.

- There is no sick ward to house students who have fallen ill. No staff member is delegated the task of attending to sick students. The children receive medicine only when the warden is on campus. Regular health check-ups do not take place.
- Very young children were also enrolled in the school due to inflated ages on their Aadhaar cards as the government mandates that all enrolments be fulfilled according to the date of birth details furnished in the Aadhaar card.. In this respect, the hands of the authorities of the school are tied.
- Waste is collected and burnt in the school premises whereas sanitary napkins are thrown on the ground inside the school compound.

Bhatko

Infrastructure

- Electricity supply is highly irregular. The children have to eat in the dark on most evenings. The solar panel in the school campus is non-functional.
- Water supply is erratic because of the power-cuts. Drinking water is managed from the hand pump. The quality of water is questionable.
- There exists 11 functional toilets. A few others are broken. The condition of sanitation is poor because of unavailability of water.
- The sink in the kitchen needs fixing.
- The classrooms do not have desks and benches. The kids sit on mats. The blackboards in some classes are broken, laid on the floor and unused.
- There are no fans in classrooms and it gets really warm and humid on most days, making it difficult for the kids to sit and study.
- The school has a namesake playground. However, it is covered in weeds and is a slope, uneven at parts, unfit for children to play in.

Food

- The nutritious value of the food is doubtful. On most mornings, the kids only receive plain rice, dal with pickle and papad. Non-vegetarian food like eggs and chicken is not regularly available.
- Though there exists variety in the vegetables curries, quantity is sometimes an issue especially with mid-day meal. The students eat three-meal a day, which is entirely a rice meal each time.

The raw rice is usually unclean, consisting of rat feces and stones, needing tremendous efforts by the cooks to clean it.

- The school is making preparations for its own kitchen garden.

Staffing

1. Teaching Staff

- There is five teaching staff out of which one teacher is on maternity leave. Noticeably, there has been no arrangement to take her place.
- The teachers reported that their salaries are not being deposited on time, and are often paid in 2-3 months in lump sum.
- The lack of accountant in the school overburdens the work of teachers.
- Teachers are not made permanent and the 7th Pay Commission is not being implemented.
- The teachers were seen taking only 2-3 classes in a period of 10 working days citing the lack of sufficient number of students to start the course, preparing records, attendance registers and miscellaneous work for the new academic year.
- Chaupal volunteers reported that the burden of teaching and tutoring falls upon them because of lack of patience on part of teachers to help the slow learners.

2. Non-teaching Staff

- The school has 5 contract-based peons (cooks and maintenance staff), who reported a similar non-timely payment of wages. The difference of time is extremely stark in the non-teaching staffs who receive wages twice in a year, in lump sum. An apparent promise of making this staff 'regular' after 5-6 years of service has still not been put into practice.

Other Issues

- The headmaster reported an allocation of Rs.900 per student in a month for overall expenses. She also reported an allocation of Rs.25,000 per year for miscellaneous purposes. A persistent complaint was the lack of reimbursement for the additional payments that the headmaster makes out of her pocket.
- Students have regular stomach aches with pain ranging from mild to severe. During the stay, the team referred a case of student with severe stomach ache to the doctor, who got eventually

diagnosed of having chronic Appendicitis and later on was admitted in the Ambikapur district government hospital.

- White patches on facial and body skin is observed which might be a resultant of lack of required nutrients, especially vitamins in the body. The students have complained about having worms in their body. It can be observed that no nutritional supplements or de-worming medication is given to the students.
- No sports equipment is available for the children's recreation and growth.
- Explicit discrimination is meted out to the Pahari Korwa children by the teaching and non-teaching staff.
- Teachers reported inefficiency in the biometric attendance system, some of which include, the lack of charge in the device stemming from constant power cuts in the region, problems while switching on the device which takes up time resulting in late registry of their attendance time.

Baijnathpur

Infrastructure

- The building has 6 operational dorms, 4 classrooms, 3 designated areas for lavatories, 1 kitchen, 1 dining hall and also separate rooms for the Principal and the watchman. However, it has been observed that flooring has cracks in it, the walls have never been painted and out of the 3 lavatories, only one is semi-operational.
- The building has an electricity connection but the electric supply is highly irregular.
- The wiring has not been done in the dorms and the classrooms. Nearly, all rooms lack fans and proper lightning for the students of the ashram.
- The blackboards in the classrooms are also not in a usable state.
- The solar panels are partially operational.
- Proper plumbing has not been done, pipes are damaged or not present at required places, which lead to unhygienic condition in the ashram.
- The building is not completely constructed. There are no open spaces or boundary walls in the ashram. The students use main road as their only play ground which places them at body-risk and is highly unsafe.

- There is an acute water shortage in the school leading to students fetching water from long distances. The bore well is dependent on electricity supply which is erratic. There are two operational hand pumps but the ground water level is severely depleted.
- The bore well water has a huge fluoride content leading to teeth defects in children.
- The sewage tank in the backyard of the school lies open providing a breeding ground for disease-causing vectors.

Food

- The menu prescribed by the authorities is not adhered to.
- The quality of food is extremely poor. The same food is fed twice a day. There is an absolute lack of fruits, milk, soya and other supplements from the diet.
- Distribution of non-vegetarian food (e.g. chicken) is skewed as most of it is reserved for the staff members and their families.
- The quality of mid-day meals is further disappointing because the lack of requisite resources such as wood, pulses, rice and vegetables.
- The store room contains heaps of rotten vegetables and spoilt rice. The room is not cleaned at regular intervals.

Staffing

1. Teaching Staff

- The post of the Principal is vacant and the superintendent is serving as the acting Principal. The acting-Principal does not stay on campus citing his overburdening responsibilities of the Sarmana Ashram.
- There are two male teachers. It was noticed that they did not attend to the students regularly and generally skipped classes.

2. Non-teaching Staff

- There are six non-teaching staff members out of which one is regular and present in the school. There are three contractual workers out of which one is absent with no information known to the authorities, one is attached to Sarmana Ashram and one is on medical leave. There are three daily wage workers.

- None of them stays as the night watchman most of the time and the Chaupal activist has to act as the watchman alone in such circumstances.

Other issues

- The misallocation of fund is a major concern. The per student allocation is Rs. 900. The quality and quality of food do not tally with the allocation. There is obvious corruption coupled with the constrained budget.
- The friction between the Pahadi Korwas and other tribes in the school is another concern. The Principal exhibits preferential treatment towards the non-Pahadi Korwa students during admission citing the tendency of Pahadi Korwa students to run off the campus as the reason.
- It was found that students participate in vegetable cutting, water lifting, sweeping the floor, cleaning rice despite the appointment of 6 peons in the school.
- Tobacco consumption by students is an issue of concern.
- It was observed that some employees visit the school campus in an inebriated state.
- Sports equipments are not made available to the students. Stocks were discovered by the team in locked cupboards.

Govindpur

Infrastructure

- Water supply in the school is of major concern. A pipe connected to the bore well at the warden's quarter is used for drinking water supply. There is no mechanism to filter the water.
- Students use the nearest water body to bathe and defecate. For chores like washing clothes and utensils, they resort to the nearby '*naali*'.
- The capacity of water tanks is insufficient to last the school for a day. It is aggravated by the irregular electricity supply. The water tanks are also not cleaned regularly.
- The three toilets prove to be inadequate for 50 children and remain extremely unhygienic. The washrooms are used for urination and washing of clothes and utensils. Three other toilets are not in use.
- The drainage system is extremely poor and the toilets get blocked very frequently. The students are made to treat the blockage manually.

Food

- The quality of the food under the warden's authority (hostel fund) is deteriorated than what they get during the mid-day meal. The food, overall, lacks proteins, essential vitamins and minerals and is a major cause of low BMI among the students.
- The morning and evening '*naashta*' are occasionally given. On Sundays and other holidays, the students are fed two meals, breakfast and dinner.
- Drinking water is stored in drums that are unclean and no utensils are maintained to consume drinking water.

Staffing

- The warden does not stay in campus and is largely ignorant of all matters regarding the welfare of the students.
- There are two contractual teachers in the school. The teachers have regular complaints with the warden regarding matters like admission. They are not satisfied with the pay scale they receive.
- The students of class 1, 2 and 3 sit in the same classroom and 4th and 5th standards sit as another class. So, proper division of curriculum becomes almost impossible. This is because of the inadequacy of teachers in the school.
- There are two female staff members for preparing the mid day meal and they do their job properly.
- The Ashram have four other domestic staff members, out of which two are on daily wage basis and the other two are regular. However, not all of them are regularly present.

Other Issues

- Security of the students is compromised in the absence of a warden. Even during the school hours, the students run away to their homes. There is no record maintained by the hostel regarding the presence and absence of students.
- The health of the students remains neglected. The students have very less Body Mass Index and skin problems are common too.
- They are not provided with toothpaste and toothbrush to maintain the dental hygiene. The bed-sheets and the blankets are not cleaned.

- Consumption of tobacco, *gutka*, *maghur*, etc. among students is a serious concern. Alcohol consumption by students is an issue too.
- All the teachers have enrolled their names in the biometric system for registering their attendance. They have been provided with a tablet for the purpose. Connectivity becomes a problem and two or three days of attendance is fed together.

Tirang

Infrastructure

- Although the school has a decent infrastructure and the building is not quite old, the roofs leak at a few places. Walls and ceilings at a few places are dampened.
- The playground used by the students is not in the school campus.
- There are three classrooms for five classes which are well lit and painted. There is no furniture for students who are supposed to sit on the carpet.
- The seven dormitories are equipped with 62 beds and mosquito nets.
- The school had a regular electricity supply.
- Fans and lights were non-functional in most classrooms and dormitories.
- The electric water purifier is out of order.
- The kitchen that was made with the construction of the school is not in use. Food is cooked on mud ‘*chulha*’ and there is a kitchen shed which is used store the raw materials.
- There are 6 toilets out of which 3 were functioning. There are 6 functioning bathrooms as well. There were 10 basins out of which 3 were functioning

Food

- The kids are fed rice and dal for all the three meals, with vegetables for most of the days and with chicken or egg for 2 days in a month. The menu in the school is not followed at all.
- The breakfast is served at 9 am, lunch by 1 pm and dinner by 7 pm. There is gap of at least 14 hours between the dinner and breakfast. No mid day meal is served on Sundays.
- The expenditure on food is incurred from the per head allowance of the children (900*70=63000 per month). The money allocated for the students is the source to fund the food consumed by the teaching and non teaching staffs as well. No additional money is granted for their food as well.

- The children drink the water from the tap. The water is clean and did not appear harmful to the team.

Staffing

- There are 4 teaching staff members. The teachers are qualified but are not trained to create a good learning environment for the children.
- There are 5 non teaching staff members. Out of them, one is permanent, one is contractual and three are daily wage workers. Two local female staff cook the mid day meal.
- There is no delegation of work for the non-teaching staff.
- The 7th Pay Commission is not being implemented.
- The bio-metric attendance system is properly in place with no shortcomings.

Other Issues

- The Pahadi Korwa students are secluded by the teaching and non-teaching staff alike.
- Health of the students is neglected by the administration. Most sick students are sent back to their homes.
- The storage of utensils is a big problem. There is no specific place for the cooking utensils. They are kept in the dormitory or in the corridor only.

Mareya

Infrastructure

- Drinking water and water for all uses is pumped from ground and stored in tank above, 4 tanks serve as drinking, washing and bathing water.
- No taps or sanitary arrangements in the bathrooms make them obsolete. Both boys and girls use the forest for their sanitation purposes.
- There are no fans in 4 rooms accommodating 12 beds each.
- The three functioning classrooms and one SMART classroom has no fans.
- Electricity on the whole was an issue until it got fixed by the hostel-in charge and teachers.
- Inverter (possibly solar power) works in times when there is no electricity in days.

Food

- Two meals (morning and evening) are cooked for hostel students comprising of rice, dal or subji. The quality of food is very poor.
- Mid-Day-Meals are cooked by other cooks in afternoon for all school children including hostel students.

Staffing

- The last hostel in-charge was recently transferred on the charges of irregularity. The new hostel in-charge was in the process of assuming responsibilities.
- Classes were divided as 1+2+3 together in one classroom and 4 and 5 each in the other two rooms, thus effectively sharing three teachers in 3 rooms.
- Classes are held sporadically, teachers are often called for other meetings and responsibilities in the circle office in Kedma.

Other Issues

- The 1+2+3 cluster has students who should be at pre-nursery level but are put together with students who are versed with alphabets and numbers. The hostel inmates are very reluctant to be a part of the school system. Pahadi Korwa boys start bunking school from assembly onwards.
- People present in school including village children discriminate against the Pahadi Korwa students. The standard class divisions were village girl students, village boy students and Pahadi Korwa boys separately.

Recommendations

While this section lays out some recommendations for each set of issues outlined earlier, **the overarching recommendation remains that the residential schools being run by the Department of Tribal and Scheduled Caste Development should meet the standards and norms mandated by Right to education (RTE) Act, 2009.**

Infrastructure

- Electricity supply (through solar panels) should be ensured in all schools.
- Functional running water system within the school campus should be set up in all schools. Motors to ensure water supply should be ensured. In schools with electric motors, the capacity of water tanks needs to be increased.
- A filtering system for drinking water should be put in place.
- Sewage tanks need maintenance to avoid blockage and proper functioning.
- An adequate number of functioning toilets and bathrooms are required in all schools.
- Non-functional fans and lights should be replaced in classrooms, toilets, dormitories and kitchen/mess.
- Repair funds should be provided to the school administrations to undertake these activities.
- Library facilities should be made available in all schools. While most schools have a provision for the same, the system remains dysfunctional.

Food

- The budget allocation for food and miscellaneous needs of each child remains Rs. 900 per month. It is strongly recommended that the budget for food be increased with immediate effect.
- The prescribed menu in the schools needs to be changed to include items of higher nutritional value (milk, fruits, porridge, eggs, meat, etc.). The menu for breakfast (rice, *dal* and vegetable) needs to be changed in particular in order to ensure intake of carbohydrate-rich diet.
- In the absence of mid-day meals on non-working days, food should be arranged for students out of the hostel fund
- Meal timings need to be standardized to ensure adequate spacing between the meals.

- Most schools do not have a set timing for evening tea. It is important that refreshments be provided to students in the gap between lunch and dinner.
- The mid-day meal scheme should be strictly implement in order to ensure the ready availability of required resources and good quality of food.
- Kitchen gardens should be started, wherever possible.

Staffing

- The regulations of the 7th Pay Commission should be implemented with immediate effect.
- The general administration, hostel administration and teaching responsibilities should be clearly separated.
- The issue of absence of Wardens/Principals from campuses for a vast stretch of time should be addressed
- The number of teachers should be increased so that each class can be attended to and merging of classes (1+2+3 and 4+5) does not happen.
- The delegation of duties for the non-teaching staff (cleaning staff, cook, peon, etc.) should be properly done in order to ensure proper functioning and accountability.
- Security guards/watch-men should be appointed immediately. Schools with absent security guards should look into the matter.
- The proper functioning of the school and hostel can be ensured only when the staff is paid well regularly.

Teaching and Pedagogy

- The Anganwadi centres run under ICDS need to be strengthened to adequately prepare students for primary school. A year of pre-school education should be provided to the students before entering the 1st standard. This makes teaching and learning easier for the teachers and students respectively.
- Relevant training should be provided to teachers in order to equip the faculty with modern methods of teaching and counselling.
- A school-appointed counsellor needs to be present in every school in order to address mental health problems and learning disabilities of children.

- For primary classes, lessons should be taught using activities and interactive learning materials such as play-cards, speakers, toys, etc. (Most schools are equipped with learning kits for various subjects which are underutilised.)
- Teachers should be given better training in order to deal with the issue of discrimination against the Pahadi Korwa children by the other children and staff and tend to them with greater sensitivity.
- The curriculum should include tribal folklores and stories from their community in order to sensitise the students towards their culture and the significance in sustaining it. Greater stress should also be laid on the learning of vernacular languages.
- Mechanism should be evolved to assess the performance of the teachers at regular intervals.
- Parent-teacher meetings should be conducted quarterly or half-yearly to keep the parents integrated in the process of the student's growth.

Others

- The safety of children must be prioritised while issuing permits for construction activities within the school premises.
- A trained nurse should be appointed in every school to tend to the sick children.
- A health check-up should be conducted in the school in every six months. The records of these check-ups should be meticulously maintained.
- Every school should have proper and maintained first-aid kits.
- Mosquito nets must be regularly replaced for holes or repaired.
- Norms for the kind of manual labour expected of children should set and strictly followed. There should be a clear demarcation between the kinds of work the students should and should not do.

Annexure A

Note on Training and Orientation of Volunteers

The orientation and training for volunteers of Sahpathi 2018 was aimed at equipping the volunteers with skills and pedagogical sharing with hands-on activities, giving a context of the geopolitics of Jharkhand and Chhattisgarh, and brainstorming on planning the 14 days in the schools. Volunteers of Road Teachers 2016 and Sahpathi 2017 shared their experiences from last 2 years and two short videos made on Road Teachers/ Sahpathi were also screened.

The orientation and training workshop took place on the evening of 26th and for the whole day of 27th June, 2018.

The guest trainers and speakers invited to be a part of the orientation workshop of Sahpathi 2018 were the following:

Dayamani Barla is a journalist and activist from Jharkhand and has worked extensively for land rights of the indigenous tribals in the state. She is also known as the Iron Lady of Jharkhand. Her courageous journalism has been recognized world over and she is a recipient of the Counter Media Award for Rural India. Dayamani's journalism and activism can be a guiding light for anyone interested in human rights and egalitarian development.

Stan Swamy is a social activist, researcher and writer based in Bagaicha, Ranchi. He has been working extensively on Adivasi land rights and displacement. Trained in Sociology and Social Analysis, he has been a strong voice against the displacement faced by the Adivasis and Dalits of Jharkhand.

Jaimanti and Dolly Kumari are part of Jan Jagran Shakti Sanghatan (JJSS) in Araria district of Bihar. The Buniyaadi Nirman Initiative by JJSS has been in action in the area of education for children in Bihar.

Narendra Kumar Das works at Chaupal Gramin Vikas Prashikshan Evam Shodh Sansthan, Sarguja district, Chhattisgarh. He has been working on the issues of Right to Food, MGNREGA etc from last 12 years and on Right to Forest from last 5 years. Chaupal Gramin Vikas

Prashikshan Evam Shodh Sansthan also works in several schools in Sarguja district in the field of enhancement of quality education.

Binay Pattanayak is Education Specialist at UNICEF, India and is now based in the Jharkhand office. He works for quality improvement in school education through child-friendly inclusive schools and systems, and also engages in teacher education reform and community based school management as desired under the historic Right to Education Act, 2009. Previously, he was Chief Consultant (Pedagogy) to the Government of India for Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan. In this role, he guided the Center in Policy and Educational Planning and also he provided technical expertise to all the States and UTs in the areas of envisioning for quality education, curriculum/ textbook development, teacher training, teaching learning material development, effective classroom processes through active pedagogy, child – friendly learning assessment, effective use of educational technology, community participation, academic support to schools, educational research and quality management.